

Figure 7: Social network ready

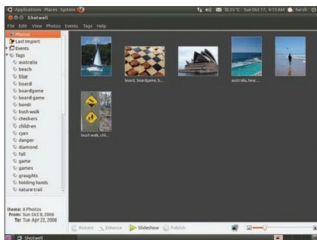


Figure 8: Shotwell



Figure 9: Better use of netbook screen real estate

Evolution, Empathy and Gwibber get tighter integration

Though most of our time is spent with Web browsers these days, Ubuntu's tighter integration of mail, chat and social networking into desktop apps will force you to switch back to desktop apps. The mail icon in the system tray is one location for all your notifications from Evolution, Empathy and Gwibber.

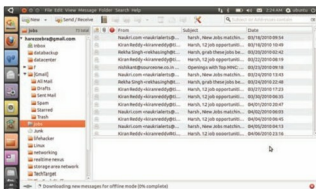


Figure 10: Evolution's compact look

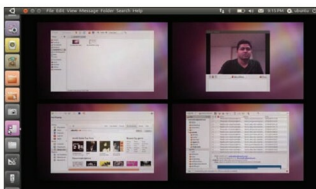


Figure 11: Workspaces



Figure 12: UNE home screen

Other improvements

There are some noticeable improvements in Update Manager too—now it also displays short descriptions of the updates. F-Spot is replaced by Shotwell as the default photo manager for organizing and making changes to photos; it has better camera and storage device detection, and the interface is very light. And, of course, many software packages have been updated to newer stable versions, such as GNOME 2.32 and Evolution 2.30.

Ubuntu netbook edition

Canonical's also released the netbook edition of Ubuntu 10.10. I took it for a trial run on my Samsung N148 netbook, and it recognised Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, the touch-pad and the Web-cam without any struggle. The new Unity interface